

Whistleblower Policy

Whistleblower Policy

Employees have the duty to comply with all applicable laws and to assist Partners to ensure legal compliance. Partners encourages its employees to report improper activities in the workplace and will protect employees from retaliation for making any such report in good faith. Employees have the right to report, without suffering retaliation, any activity by the organization or its employees that the employee reasonably believes:

- Violates any local, state, or federal law
- Violates or amounts to noncompliance with any local, state, or federal rule or regulation
- Violates fiduciary responsibilities by a corporation to its stakeholders or employees

In addition, employees can refuse to participate in an activity that would result in a violation of, or noncompliance with, any local, state, or federal statutes, rules or regulations. Employees are also protected from retaliation for having exercised any of these rights in any former employment. The whistleblower protection laws do not entitle employees to violate a confidential privilege of the organization (such as attorney-client privilege) or improperly disclose trade-secret information.

Whistleblower Complaint Procedure

Any employee who suspects a violation of ethics or legal compliance is required to report the situation(s) to their supervisor or a member of Senior Management. Alternatively, a confidential hotline at bbulger@fosterthomas.com has been established for you to report your concern via voicemail message to an outside party. The voicemail is monitored by an HR Consultant from Foster Thomas who will relay any concerns to the Ethics Committee of the Board. If the situation is life-threatening or extremely critical in nature, it needs to be reported to Senior Management as well the hotline for immediate action to be taken. Employees may also report information regarding possible unlawful activity to an appropriate government or law enforcement agency.

Protection from Retaliation for Whistleblower Complaint

Federal and state laws prohibit employers from discharging an employee or taking other adverse employment action against an employee in retaliation for the employee's good faith complaint about safety and health hazards or other violations of law in the workplace and the environment. These whistleblower protections are in addition to protection or rights provided by other applicable laws.